

Challenge Name: time capsule - 150 (MISC)

Challenge Info

time capsule

150

Description Hints 38 Solves

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Description

you can't always get what you want

Link: [time_capsule.zip](#)

Hints

View Hint

Flag

Files: drop.jpg, flag.zip, forum_logs.txt, pubkeys.asc, users.csv

```
(kali@kali) - [~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ ls -la
total 496
drwxrwxr-x 2 kali kali 4096 Sep 27 00:30 .
drwxrwxr-x 3 kali kali 4096 Sep 27 00:30 ..
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 6673 Sep 7 19:06 drop.jpg
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 189 Sep 7 19:14 flag.zip
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 5182 Sep 7 18:44 forum_logs.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 6782 Sep 14 12:43 pubkeys.asc
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 468928 Sep 7 18:44 users.csv

(kali@kali) - [~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$
```

Goal: Find and extract the flag from the provided archive.

Steps

1 Inspect the files

```
ls -l
file drop.jpg
unzip -l flag.zip # shows flag.txt
```

```
(kali@kali) - [~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ ls -l
total 496
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 6673 Sep 7 19:06 drop.jpg
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 27 Sep 7 19:13 flag.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 189 Sep 7 19:14 flag.zip
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 5182 Sep 7 18:44 forum_logs.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 6782 Sep 14 12:43 pubkeys.asc
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 46 Sep 27 00:50 steganopayload674373.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 kali kali 468928 Sep 7 18:44 users.csv

(kali@kali) - [~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ file drop.jpg
drop.jpg: JPEG image data, JFIF standard 1.01, aspect ratio, density 1x1, segment length 16, baseline, precision 8, 640x480, components 3

(kali@kali) - [~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ unzip -l flag.zip
Archive:  flag.zip
Length Date Time Name
----
27 2025-09-07 19:13 flag.txt
27 1 file

(kali@kali) - [~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$
```

- `drop.jpg` → suspicious image (possible stego)
- `flag.zip` → password-protected ZIP containing `flag.txt`
- `pubkeys.asc` → lots of PGP public keys (red herring)

2 Find the stego passphrase

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ grep -n "Comment:" pubkeys.asc
139:Comment: FE5WUEBeqzXL3V4xYsrs4Q
```

- `pubkeys.asc` had a `Comment:` field: `FE5WUEBeqzXL3V4xYsrs4Q`
- Decoding it as **Base58** gave the stego passphrase:

Recipe	Input
From Base58 Alphabet 123456789ABCDEFGHJKLMNPQRSTUVWXYZabc... ☐ Remove non-alphabet chars	FE5WUEBeqzXL3V4xYsrs4Q abc 22 1 Output s3cr3t-pass-2025

Password: `s3cr3t-pass-2025`

3 Extract the hidden payload from the image

```
steghide extract -sf drop.jpg -p 's3cr3t-pass-2025'
cat steganopayload674373.txt
```

Payload contents:

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ steghide extract -sf drop.jpg -p 's3cr3t-pass-2025'
the file "steganopayload674373.txt" does already exist. overwrite ? (y/n) y
wrote extracted data to "steganopayload674373.txt".

(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$ cat steganopayload674373.txt
Huhh.. you will lose!!
Use `ZipUp` to unlock.

(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
$
```

The payload tells us the ZIP password: `ZipUp`

4 Unlock the ZIP and get the flag

```
unzip -P ZipUp flag.zip
cat flag.txt
```

Flag:

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
└─$ unzip -P ZipUp flag.zip
Archive:  flag.zip
  extracting: flag.txt

(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
└─$ cat flag.txt
0001111time_capsule_of_lies

(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/time_capsule]
└─$
```

✓ Summary

- `pubkeys.asc` → red herring (ignore)
- `drop.jpg` → stego container
- Base58 decode of the `Comment:` field → stego passphrase
- Payload inside image → ZIP password hint
- `flag.zip` → actual flag

Final

Simple and classic — hidden payload inside a stego image led to the ZIP password.

Flag: `SPL{0001111time_capsule_of_lies}`

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